ALBORZ ECOLOGY

BRIEF SUMMARY OF ARBORZ

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INTRODUCTION

Briefly elaborate on the Alborz Mountain Range

The Alborz Mountains rise between the Caspian Sea and Iran’s central plateau, their towering peaks meeting the sky. From lush northern forests to rugged, snow-covered heights, this majestic range reveals nature’s beauty in its most striking forms.

GEOGRAPHY AND BIOLOGY

THE ALBORZ MOUNTAIN RANGE STRETCHES ACROSS A VAST PART OF NORTHERN IRAN





The Alborz Mountain Range forms a vast arc across northern Iran, stretching from the Astara region in the northwest, along the southern coast of the Caspian Sea, and eastward toward the mountains of Khorasan.

It extends near cities such as Astara, Rasht, Ramsar, Chalus, Amol, Sari, Gorgan, and Tehran.

The range is approximately 900 kilometers long, with its width exceeding 100 kilometers in some areas



The Southern Slopes — Where the Land Grows Dry

As the Alborz Mountains block much of the moisture coming from the Caspian Sea, the southern slopes receive considerably less rainfall. This creates a drier landscape, with sparse vegetation and arid terrain extending toward Iran’s central plateau.

The Northern Slopes — A World of Green

Moist air from the Caspian Sea rises over the Alborz Mountains, cools, and releases rainfall across the northern slopes. This abundant moisture supports the lush Hyrcanian forests, creating a landscape rich in vegetation and biodiversity.

TWO WORLDS, ONE MOUNTAIN RANGE

SOME FAMOUS MOUNTAINS OF ALBORZ



Mazandaran Province
northern Iran, in the Alborz Mountain Range

1 Mount Damavand

5,610 m · Highest peak in Iran
It is the highest volcano in Asia

2 Alam Kuh

About 4,850 m · One of Iran’s highest peaks
Its steep northern face rises roughly 800 meters

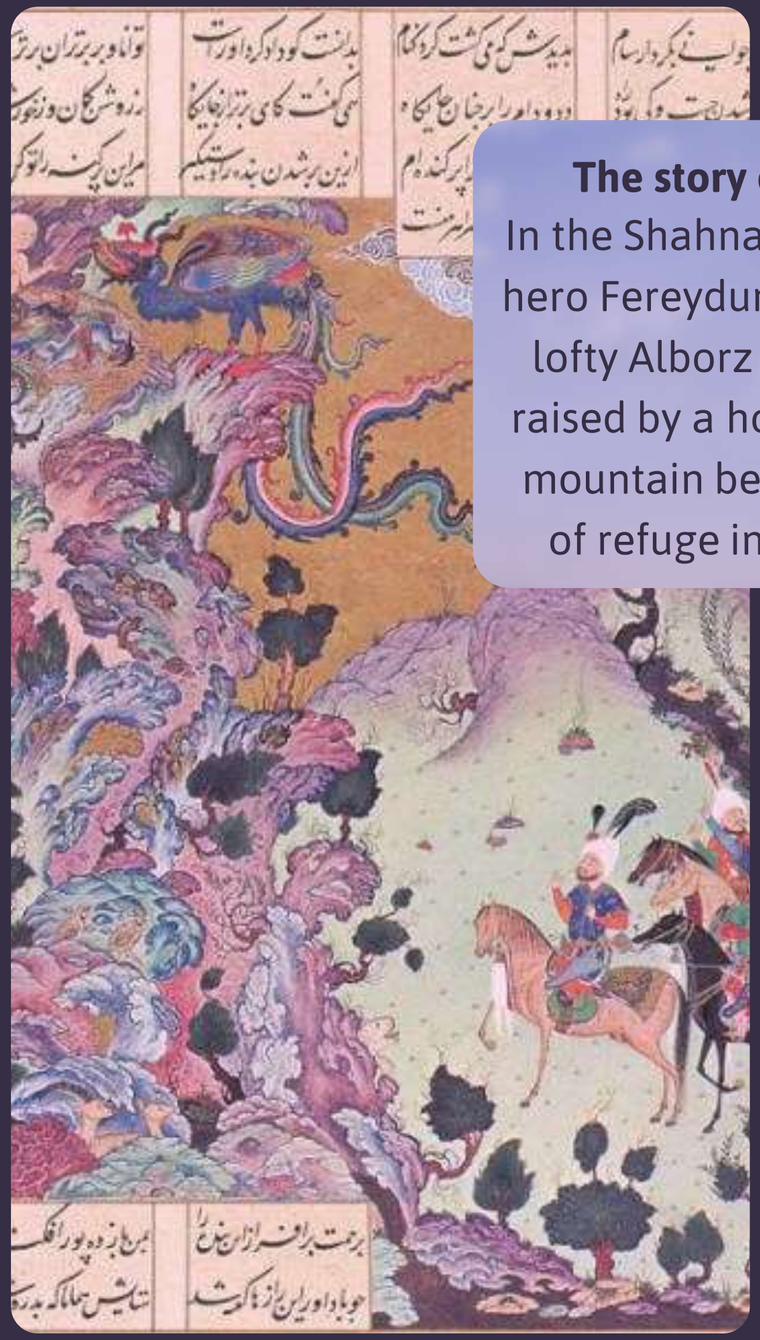
3 Mount Tochal

About 3,964 m · North of Tehran
A gondola lift carries visitors high into the mountains from the Tehran area



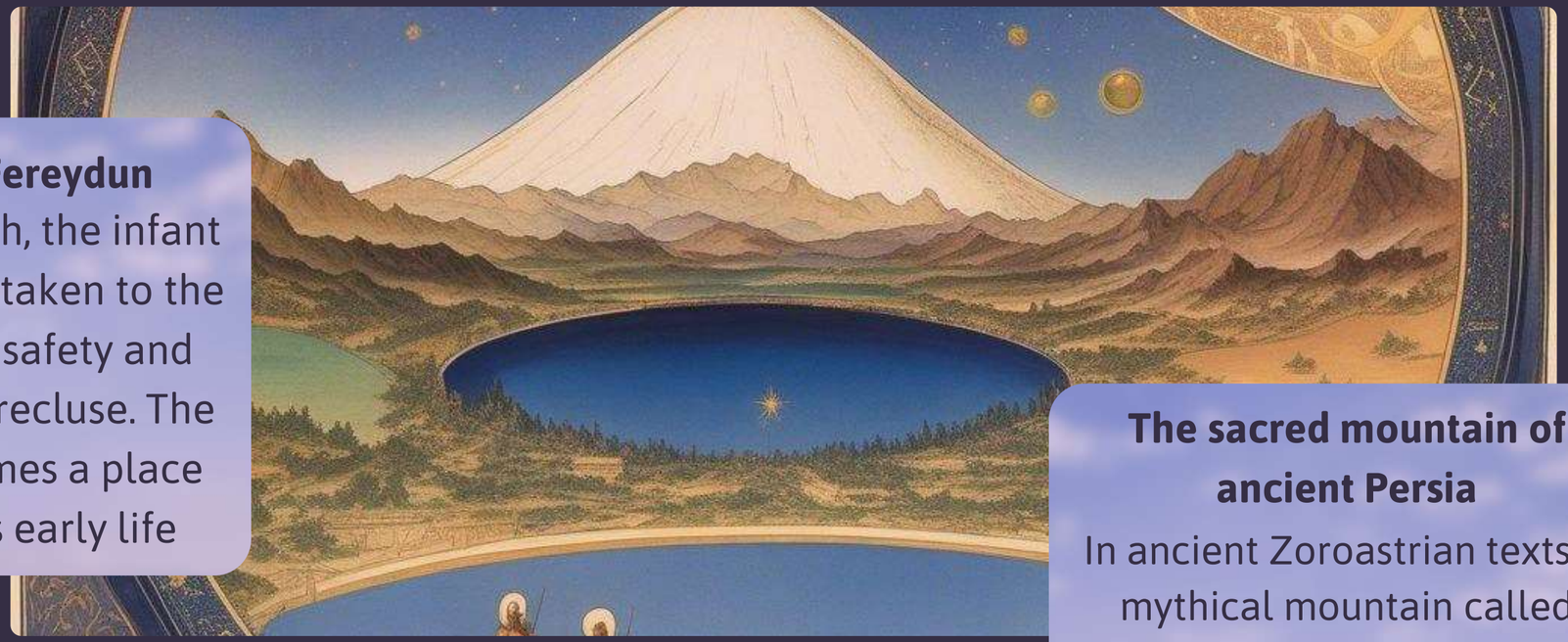
MYTHS TO WILDLIFE

BEYOND ITS UNIQUE HABITATS, THE ALBORZ MOUNTAIN RANGE HAS INSPIRED LEGENDARY TALES THROUGHOUT PERSIAN HISTORY.



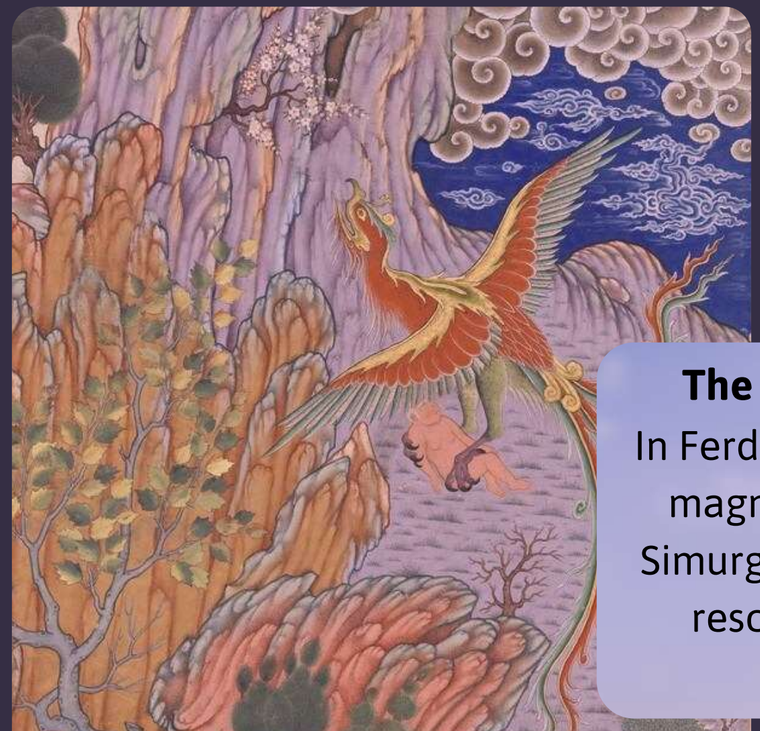
The story of Fereydun

In the Shahnameh, the infant hero Fereydun is taken to the lofty Alborz for safety and raised by a holy recluse. The mountain becomes a place of refuge in his early life



The sacred mountain of ancient Persia

In ancient Zoroastrian texts, a mythical mountain called Hara Berezaiti was described as a cosmic mountain around which the stars, Moon, and Sun moved. Its name is historically connected to the name Alborz



The legendary Simurgh

In Ferdowsi's Shahnameh, the magnificent mythical bird Simurgh nests on Alborz. She rescues the abandoned infant Zal

NOT ALL ALBORZ CREATURES BELONG TO LEGEND.

The Alborz Mountains are home to more than 156 bird species, including kestrels (دلیجه), falcons (شاهین), see-see partridges (کوکر شکم‌سیاه), golden eagles (عقاب طلایی), Caspian snowcocks (کبک دری), and chukar partridges (کبک چیل). The range also supports 48 mammal species, such as stone martens (سمور سنگی), red deer (مرال), wolves (گرگ), brown bears (خرس قهوه‌ای), wild sheep (قوچ و میش وحشی), wild goats (کل و بز وحشی), wildcats (گربه وحشی), porcupines (تشی), and leopards (پلنگ). Its wildlife includes 26 reptile species and 7 amphibian species, including the Alborz viper (افعی البرزی), Caucasian viper (افعی قفقازی), and saw-scaled viper (افعی جعفری). The northern region is also home to 17 fish species.



Persian brook salamander

A rare amphibian found in mountain streams in the Alborz and Talesh ranges. It is native to Iran, but it is not confirmed to live exclusively in the Alborz.

HAZARDS AND DANGERS

ALTHOUGH BEAUTIFUL, THE ALBORZ MOUNTAINS ARE NOT FREE FROM DANGER



Between 2012 and 2020, researchers recorded 19 Persian leopard attack incidents in northern Iranian provinces associated with the Alborz region. However, the exact number of attacks occurring within the Alborz Mountain Range itself remains unclear.

ALBORZ: AVALANCHE HOTSPOT

he Alborz Mountain Range is widely regarded as one of Iran’s most avalanche-prone mountainous regions.

Tehran Province:

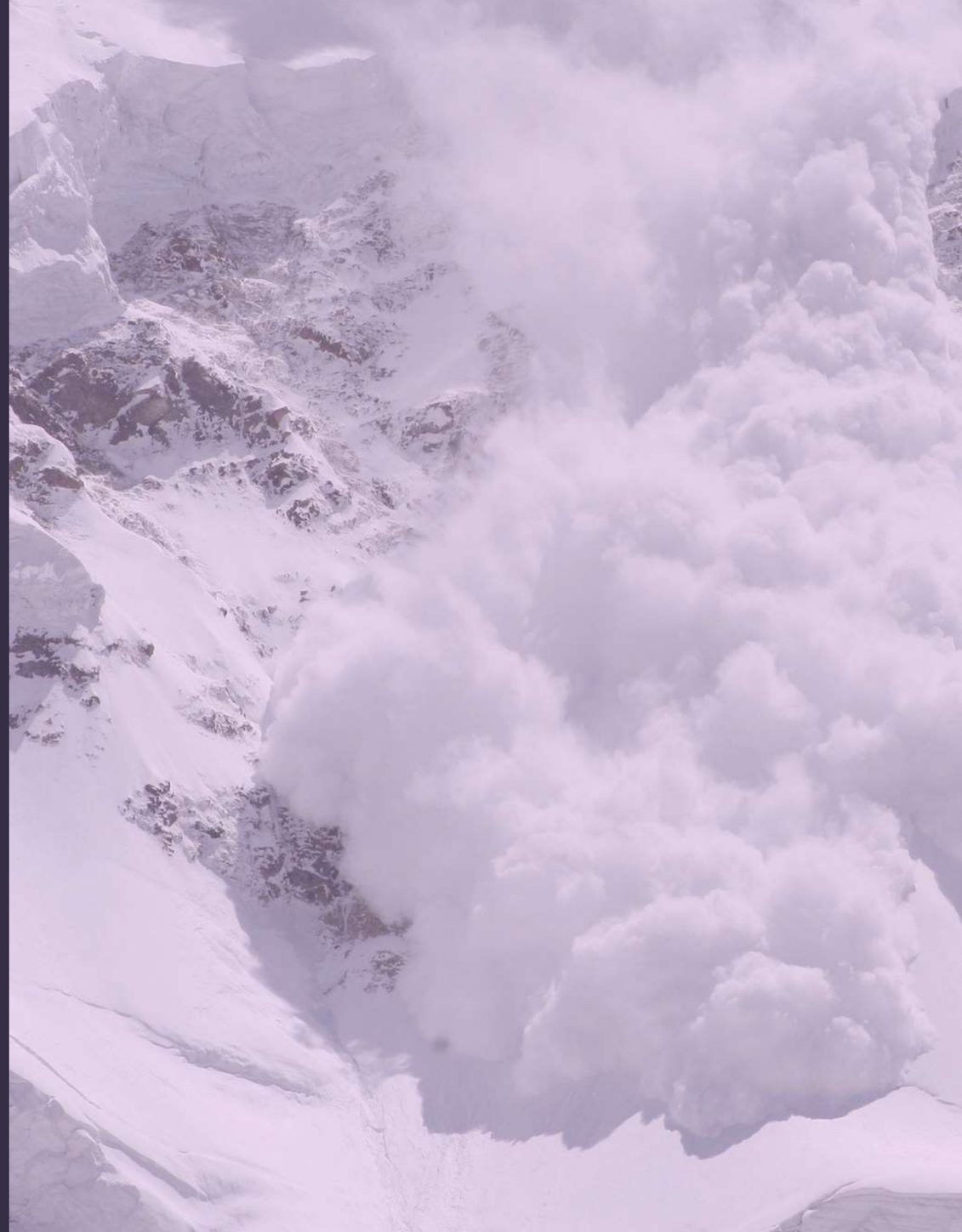
The highlands around Dizin, Tochal, Shemshak, and Lavasan are avalanche-prone due to steep slopes and heavy visitor traffic. Mount Damavand’s glaciers and northern slopes are also particularly dangerous in winter.

Mazandaran Province:

Alam Kuh, Takht-e Soleyman, and the northern slopes are avalanche-prone due to heavy, wet snowfall. Northern routes to Mount Damavand are also hazardous

Alborz Province:

The mountains around Karaj and the Taleghan highlands have considerable avalanche potential due to substantial snowfall and steep terrain.



AUTUMN 2025, STRONG WARM WINDS AND DRY SOIL CONTRIBUTED TO A SERIES OF WILDFIRES ACROSS NORTHERN IRAN. THE MAJOR FIRE LOCATIONS INCLUDED THE ELIT FORESTS NEAR CHALUS, THE ABR HYRCANIAN FORESTS ON THE SEMNAN–GOLESTAN BORDER, PISHANBUR IN KELARDASHT, DARAZNO AND RADKAN NEAR KORDKUY, SADEGHABAD NEAR GALIKESH, KARMOZD IN SAVADKUH, AND KOMLEH NEAR LANGARUD. THE ELIT FIRE LASTED MORE THAN 20 DAYS.

THE FIRES SPARKED CRITICISM OF THE GOVERNMENT'S EMERGENCY RESPONSE, AS LOCAL RESIDENTS FOUGHT THE FLAMES WITH LIMITED EQUIPMENT. SUSPICIONS OF ARSON WERE RAISED, BUT DELIBERATE CAUSES WERE NOT CONCLUSIVELY ESTABLISHED. OFFICIALS CONFIRMED THAT NO FOREIGN COUNTRIES HAD ASSISTED WITH FIREFIGHTING, WHILE CRITICS HIGHLIGHTED SHORTAGES OF FUNDING, EQUIPMENT, TRAINED PERSONNEL, AND COORDINATION.

Alborz Under Fire

THANK YOU FOR LISTENING!

IRANIAN GROUP